

BARK LICE AND BOOK LICE

Common on vegetation and in litter, insects of the order Psocoptera are small, squat, and soft-bodied. The head has thread-like antennae and bulging eyes. They eat microflora and some species are pests of stored products.

4–6 mm
1/32–1/4 in



PSOCOCERASTIS GIBBOSA
F: Psocidae

Native to Europe and parts of Asia, this relatively large bark louse can be found on a wide range of deciduous and coniferous trees.

0.6–1.5 mm
1/64–1/24 in



LIPOSCELIS LIPARIUS
F: Liposcelidae
This very widespread species favours dark, damp micro-habitats and can be a pest in libraries and granaries if the humidity is too high.

THRIPS

Members of the order Thysanoptera are tiny insects, typically with two pairs of narrow, hair-fringed wings. They have large compound eyes and distinctive mouthparts for piercing and sucking.

FLOWER THRIP
Frankliniella sp.
F: Thripidae

Flower thrips are found all over the world and can be pests on crops such as groundnut, cotton, sweet potato, and coffee.

1–1.5 mm
1/32–1/24 in



SNAKEFLIES

Snakeflies, in the order Raphidioptera, are woodland insects with a long prothorax, a broad head, and two pairs of wings. Adults and larvae eat aphids and other soft prey.

1.6–1.8 cm
1/2–3/4 in



RAPHIDIA NOTATA
F: Raphidiidae

Found in deciduous or coniferous woodlands in Europe, this snakefly is usually associated with oak trees, where it eats aphids.

ALDERFLIES AND DOBSONFLIES

The Megaloptera have two pairs of wings, which are held roof-like over the body when they are at rest. The aquatic larvae, which are predatory and have abdominal gills, pupate on land in soil, moss, or rotting wood.

EASTERN DOBSONFLY
Corydalus cornutus
F: Corydalidae

Found in N. America, the male of this species has very long mandibles used for combat and for gripping the female.



10–14 cm
4–5 1/2 in



ALDERFLY
Sialis lutaria
F: Sialidae

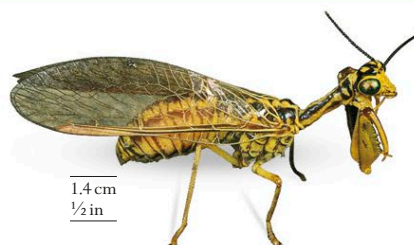
The female of this widespread species lays a mass of up to 2,000 eggs on twigs or leaves near water.

1.4–2.6 cm
1/2–1 in

LACEWINGS AND RELATIVES

Insects of the order Neuroptera have conspicuous eyes and biting mouthparts. The pairs of net-veined wings are held roof-like over the body at rest. The larvae have sickle-shaped mouthparts, which form sharp, sucking tubes.

1.4 cm
1/2 in



MANTISPA STYRIACA
F: Mantispidae

Like a miniature praying mantid, this species, found in S. and C. Europe, lives in lightly wooded areas, where it hunts small flies.

3 cm
1 1/4 in



OWLFly
Libelloides macaronius
F: Ascalaphidae

Capturing insect prey in mid-air, this species will only fly on warm sunny days. It can be found in C. and S. Europe and parts of Asia.

GIANT LACEWING
Osmylus fulvicephalus
F: Osmylidae

This European species can be found among shady woodland vegetation by streams, where it eats small insects and pollen.

1.3 cm
1/2 in

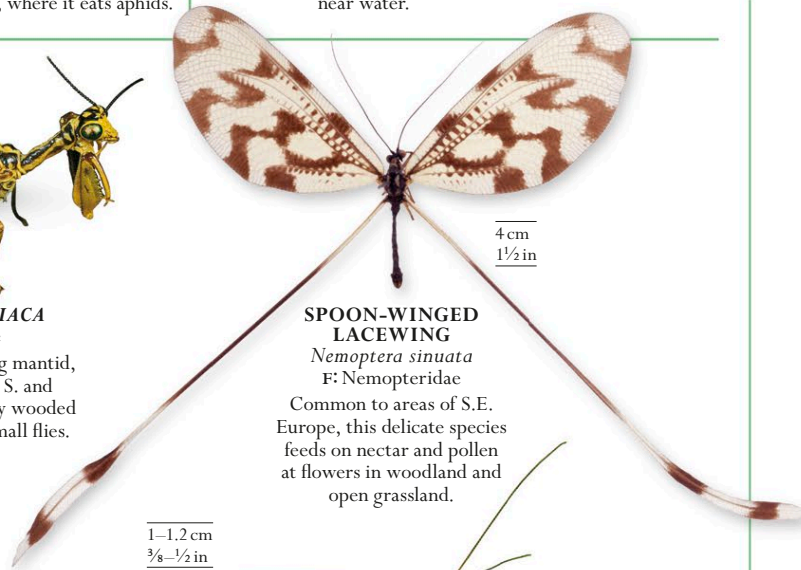


spotted wings

SPOON-WINGED LACEWING
Nemoptera sinuata
F: Nemopteridae

Common to areas of S.E. Europe, this delicate species feeds on nectar and pollen at flowers in woodland and open grassland.

1–1.2 cm
3/8–1/2 in



GREEN LACEWING
Chrysopa perla
F: Chrysopidae

This widespread European species has a characteristic bluish green tinge and black markings and is commonly found in deciduous woodland.



ANTLION
Palpares libelluloides
F: Myrmeleontidae

This large, day-flying, Mediterranean species with distinctively mottled wings can be found in rough grassland, warm scrubby habitats, and sand dunes.

5–5.5 cm
2–2 1/4 in

males have organs for clasping females

